

Development, simulation & implementation of precoding techniques for satellite links

Wannes Baes

Student number: 02011242

Supervisor: Prof. dr. ir. Nele Noels

Counsellor: Dr. ir. Rodrigo Moraes (Antwerp Space)

Master's dissertation submitted in order to obtain the degree of Master of Science in Computer Science Engineering

Academic year 2025-2026

This master's dissertation is part of an exam. Any comments formulated by the assessment committee during the oral presentation of the master's dissertation are not included in this text.

The author gives permission to make this master's dissertation available for consultation and to copy parts of this master's dissertation for personal use. In the case of any other use, the copyright terms have to be respected, in particular with regard to the obligation to state expressly the source when quoting results from this master's dissertation.

Ghent, May 2026

Wannes Baes

Acknowledgements

Laboris magna irure quis sit et veniam voluptate duis elit esse do excepteur. Officia laboris adipisicing laboris duis ut cillum aliquip. Do veniam aute non do cillum sit pariatur consectetur adipisicing qui. Lorem Lorem veniam minim exercitation cupidatat tempor do aute dolore. Nostrud adipisicing tempor quis qui fugiat sint quis ut aute eiusmod Lorem enim veniam. Elit labore Lorem do proident amet anim exercitation culpa enim cillum qui. Aliquip reprehenderit commodo labore minim laborum mollit ut veniam in irure. Minim sit in non aliqua ut elit veniam irure pariatur non velit consequat. Cupidatat veniam occaecat culpa eu irure aute consectetur dolore culpa deserunt quis officia do. Aliqua aliqua eu velit excepteur culpa ea dolore occaecat. Ea est cillum nulla ea cupidatat esse adipisicing ut. Cillum amet esse ex ex enim elit excepteur ullamco in qui aliqua Lorem veniam. Sunt consectetur aliquip commodo exercitation pariatur id tempor adipisicing aliqua. Fugiat cillum ea irure laborum consectetur ipsum. Excepteur laboris eu veniam ex ad consequat esse id ullamco ea cupidatat ad nisi. Aute nisi velit excepteur adipisicing dolore pariatur sunt. Dolore mollit cupidatat esse sint ipsum est nulla nisi eu cupidatat excepteur sint cillum. Culpa irure magna culpa eiusmod ut nisi ipsum veniam elit est occaecat veniam. Sunt adipisicing eu minim qui ea laboris ullamco ut. Aliquip occaecat in occaecat ut tempor dolore sunt consequat qui cillum reprehenderit. Voluptate commodo cupidatat ullamco sint aliquip veniam consequat do. Nisi velit excepteur aute laboris aliqua fugiat minim occaecat quis non incididunt.

Development, simulation & implementation of precoding techniques for satellite links

by

WANNES BAES

Master's dissertation submitted in order to obtain the academic degree of Master of Science in
Computer Science Engineering

Supervisor: Prof. Dr. ir. Nele Noels

Counsellor: Dr. ir. Rodrigo Moraes (Antwerp Space)

Ghent University

Faculty of Engineering and Architecture

Department of Telecommunications and Information Processing

Abstract — Laboris magna irure quis sit et veniam voluptate duis elit esse do excepteur. Officia laboris adipisicing laboris duis ut cillum aliquip. Do veniam aute non do cillum sit pariatur consectetur adipisicing qui. Lorem Lorem veniam minim exercitation cupidatat tempor do aute dolore. Nostrud adipisicing tempor quis qui fugiat sint quis ut aute eiusmod Lorem enim veniam. Elit labore Lorem do proident amet anim exercitation culpa enim cillum qui. Aliquip reprehenderit commodo labore minim laborum mollit ut veniam in irure. Minim sit in non aliqua ut elit veniam irure pariatur non velit consequat. Cupidatat veniam occaecat culpa eu irure aute consectetur dolore culpa deserunt quis officia do. Aliqua aliqua eu velit excepteur culpa ea dolore occaecat. Ea est cillum nulla ea cupidatat esse adipisicing ut. Cillum amet esse ex ex enim elit excepteur ullamco in qui aliqua Lorem veniam. Sunt consectetur aliquip commodo exercitation pariatur id tempor adipisicing aliqua. Fugiat cillum ea irure laborum consectetur ipsum. Excepteur laboris eu veniam ex ad consequat esse id ullamco ea cupidatat ad nisi. Aute nisi velit excepteur adipisicing dolore pariatur sunt. Dolore mollit cupidatat esse sint ipsum est nulla nisi eu cupidatat excepteur sint cillum. Culpa irure magna culpa eiusmod ut nisi ipsum veniam elit est occaecat veniam. Sunt adipisicing eu minim qui ea laboris ullamco ut. Aliquip occaecat in occaecat ut tempor dolore sunt consequat qui cillum reprehenderit. Voluptate commodo cupidatat ullamco sint aliquip veniam consequat do. Nisi velit excepteur aute laboris aliqua fugiat minim occaecat quis non incididunt.

Keywords — Laboris magna, Laboris magna, Laboris magna, Laboris magna

Development, simulation & implementation of precoding techniques for satellite links

Wannes Baes

Supervisor: Prof. Dr. ir. Nele Noels (Ghent University)

Counsellor: Dr. ir. Rodrigo Moraes (Antwerp Space)

Abstract—This document is a model and instructions for L^AT_EX. This and the IEEEtran.cls file define the components of your paper [title, text, heads, etc.]. *CRITICAL: Do Not Use Symbols, Special Characters, Footnotes, or Math in Paper Title or Abstract.

Index Terms—component, formatting, style, styling, insert

I. INTRODUCTION

This document is a model and instructions for L^AT_EX. Please observe the conference page limits.

II. EASE OF USE

A. Maintaining the Integrity of the Specifications

The IEEEtran class file is used to format your paper and style the text. All margins, column widths, line spaces, and text fonts are prescribed; please do not alter them. You may note peculiarities. For example, the head margin measures proportionately more than is customary. This measurement and others are deliberate, using specifications that anticipate your paper as one part of the entire proceedings, and not as an independent document. Please do not revise any of the current designations.

III. PREPARE YOUR PAPER BEFORE STYLING

Before you begin to format your paper, first write and save the content as a separate text file. Complete all content and organizational editing before formatting. Please note sections III-A–III-E below for more information on proofreading, spelling and grammar.

Keep your text and graphic files separate until after the text has been formatted and styled. Do not number text heads—L^AT_EX will do that for you.

A. Abbreviations and Acronyms

Define abbreviations and acronyms the first time they are used in the text, even after they have been defined in the abstract. Abbreviations such as IEEE, SI, MKS, CGS, ac, dc, and rms do not have to be defined. Do not use abbreviations in the title or heads unless they are unavoidable.

B. Units

- Use either SI (MKS) or CGS as primary units. (SI units are encouraged.) English units may be used as secondary units (in parentheses). An exception would be the use of English units as identifiers in trade, such as “3.5-inch disk drive”.
- Avoid combining SI and CGS units, such as current in amperes and magnetic field in oersteds. This often leads to confusion because equations do not balance dimensionally. If you must use mixed units, clearly state the units for each quantity that you use in an equation.
- Do not mix complete spellings and abbreviations of units: “Wb/m²” or “webers per square meter”, not “webers/m²”. Spell out units when they appear in text: “. . . a few henries”, not “. . . a few H”.
- Use a zero before decimal points: “0.25”, not “.25”. Use “cm³”, not “cc”).

C. Equations

Number equations consecutively. To make your equations more compact, you may use the solidus (/), the exp function, or appropriate exponents. Italicize Roman symbols for quantities and variables, but not Greek symbols. Use a long dash rather than a hyphen for a minus sign. Punctuate equations with commas or periods when they are part of a sentence, as in:

$$a + b = \gamma \quad (1)$$

Be sure that the symbols in your equation have been defined before or immediately following the equation. Use “(1)”, not “Eq. (1)” or “equation (1)”, except at the beginning of a sentence: “Equation (1) is . . .”

D. L^AT_EX-Specific Advice

Please use “soft” (e.g., `\eqref{Eq}`) cross references instead of “hard” references (e.g., (1)). That will make it possible to combine sections, add equations, or change the order of figures or citations without having to go through the file line by line.

Please don’t use the `{eqnarray}` equation environment. Use `{align}` or `{IEEEeqnarray}` instead. The `{eqnarray}` environment leaves unsightly spaces around relation symbols.

Please note that the `{subequations}` environment in $\LaTeX$ will increment the main equation counter even when there are no equation numbers displayed. If you forget that, you might write an article in which the equation numbers skip from (17) to (20), causing the copy editors to wonder if you’ve discovered a new method of counting.

BibTeX does not work by magic. It doesn’t get the bibliographic data from thin air but from .bib files. If you use BibTeX to produce a bibliography you must send the .bib files.

$\LaTeX$ can’t read your mind. If you assign the same label to a subsubsection and a table, you might find that Table I has been cross referenced as Table IV-B3.

$\LaTeX$ does not have precognitive abilities. If you put a `\label` command before the command that updates the counter it’s supposed to be using, the label will pick up the last counter to be cross referenced instead. In particular, a `\label` command should not go before the caption of a figure or a table.

Do not use `\nonumber` inside the `{array}` environment. It will not stop equation numbers inside `{array}` (there won’t be any anyway) and it might stop a wanted equation number in the surrounding equation.

E. Some Common Mistakes

- The word “data” is plural, not singular.
- The subscript for the permeability of vacuum μ_0 , and other common scientific constants, is zero with subscript formatting, not a lowercase letter “o”.
- In American English, commas, semicolons, periods, question and exclamation marks are located within quotation marks only when a complete thought or name is cited, such as a title or full quotation. When quotation marks are used, instead of a bold or italic typeface, to highlight a word or phrase, punctuation should appear outside of the quotation marks. A parenthetical phrase or statement at the end of a sentence is punctuated outside of the closing parenthesis (like this). (A parenthetical sentence is punctuated within the parentheses.)
- A graph within a graph is an “inset”, not an “insert”. The word alternatively is preferred to the word “alternately” (unless you really mean something that alternates).
- Do not use the word “essentially” to mean “approximately” or “effectively”.
- In your paper title, if the words “that uses” can accurately replace the word “using”, capitalize the “u”; if not, keep using lower-cased.
- Be aware of the different meanings of the homophones “affect” and “effect”, “complement” and “compliment”, “discreet” and “discrete”, “principal” and “principle”.
- Do not confuse “imply” and “infer”.
- The prefix “non” is not a word; it should be joined to the word it modifies, usually without a hyphen.
- There is no period after the “et” in the Latin abbreviation “et al.”.

- The abbreviation “i.e.” means “that is”, and the abbreviation “e.g.” means “for example”.

An excellent style manual for science writers is [1].

F. Authors and Affiliations

The class file is designed for, but not limited to, six authors. A minimum of one author is required for all conference articles. Author names should be listed starting from left to right and then moving down to the next line. This is the author sequence that will be used in future citations and by indexing services. Names should not be listed in columns nor group by affiliation. Please keep your affiliations as succinct as possible (for example, do not differentiate among departments of the same organization).

G. Identify the Headings

Headings, or heads, are organizational devices that guide the reader through your paper. There are two types: component heads and text heads.

Component heads identify the different components of your paper and are not topically subordinate to each other. Examples include Acknowledgments and References and, for these, the correct style to use is “Heading 5”. Use “figure caption” for your Figure captions, and “table head” for your table title. Run-in heads, such as “Abstract”, will require you to apply a style (in this case, italic) in addition to the style provided by the drop down menu to differentiate the head from the text.

Text heads organize the topics on a relational, hierarchical basis. For example, the paper title is the primary text head because all subsequent material relates and elaborates on this one topic. If there are two or more sub-topics, the next level head (uppercase Roman numerals) should be used and, conversely, if there are not at least two sub-topics, then no subheads should be introduced.

H. Figures and Tables

a) Positioning Figures and Tables: Place figures and tables at the top and bottom of columns. Avoid placing them in the middle of columns. Large figures and tables may span across both columns. Figure captions should be below the figures; table heads should appear above the tables. Insert figures and tables after they are cited in the text. Use the abbreviation “Fig. 1”, even at the beginning of a sentence.

TABLE I
TABLE TYPE STYLES

Table Head	Table Column Head		
	Table column subhead	Subhead	Subhead
copy	More table copy ^a		

^aSample of a Table footnote.

Figure Labels: Use 8 point Times New Roman for Figure labels. Use words rather than symbols or abbreviations when writing Figure axis labels to avoid confusing the reader. As an example, write the quantity “Magnetization”, or “Magnetization, M”, not just “M”. If including units in the label, present



Fig. 1. Example of a figure caption.

them within parentheses. Do not label axes only with units. In the example, write “Magnetization (A/m)” or “Magnetization {A[m(1)]}”, not just “A/m”. Do not label axes with a ratio of quantities and units. For example, write “Temperature (K)”, not “Temperature/K”.

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

The preferred spelling of the word “acknowledgment” in America is without an “e” after the “g”. Avoid the stilted expression “one of us (R. B. G.) thanks ...”. Instead, try “R. B. G. thanks...”. Put sponsor acknowledgments in the unnumbered footnote on the first page.

REFERENCES

- [1] A. I. Perez-Neira, M. A. Vazquez, M. B. Shankar, S. Maleki, and S. Chatzinotas, “Signal processing for high-throughput satellites: Challenges in new interference-limited scenarios,” *IEEE Signal Processing Magazine*, vol. 36, no. 4, pp. 112–131, 2019.

Contents

Acknowledgements	i
Abstract	ii
Extended Abstract	iii
Contents	vi
List of Figures	viii
List of Tables	ix
Symbols and Notations	x
Abbreviations	x
Mathematical Notations	x
System Parameters	x
Symbols	x
 I Background Material	 2
1 Communication Systems	3
1.1 Digital Communication System	3
1.2 MIMO Communication Systems	4
1.2.1 SU-MIMO	4
1.2.2 MU-MIMO	5
1.3 Capacity of a MIMO System	6
1.3.1 SU-MIMO	6
1.3.2 MU-MIMO	6
2 Precoding Techniques	6
 II Precoding with perfect CSI	 7
3 SU-MIMO Precoding	8

<i>CONTENTS</i>	vii
4 MU-MIMO Precoding	9
III Precoding for Satellite Communications	10
IV Appendices	11
A Title of appendix A	12
A Title of appendix B	13

List of Figures

1.1	Block diagram of a general digital communication system.	3
1.2	Block diagram of a SU-MIMO system.	4
1.3	Block diagram of a MU-MIMO system.	6

List of Tables

Symbols and Notations

Abbreviations

TX	transmitter
RX	receiver
BS	base station
UT	user terminal
MIMO	multiple-input multiple-output
MU	multi-user
SU	single-user
i.i.d.	independent and identically distributed

Mathematical Notations

TO DO

System Parameters

N_T	Number of transmit antennas at the BS
N_R	Number of receive antennas at each UT
N_S	Number of data streams per UT
K	Number of UTs

Symbols

TO DO

Part I

Background Material

Chapter 1

Communication Systems

1.1 Digital Communication System

A general digital communication system transfers information from a source to a destination over a physical transmission medium, referred to as the channel [1]. The corresponding block diagram is shown in Fig. 1.1.

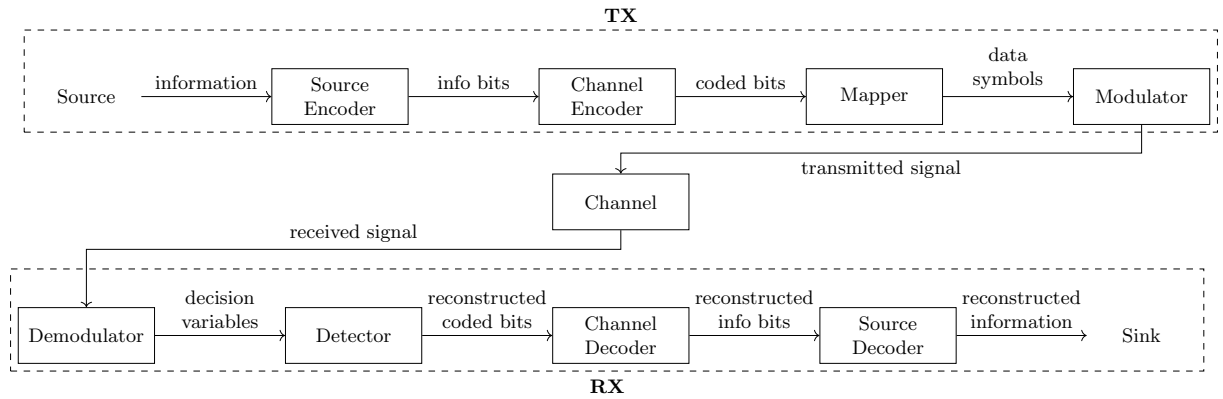


Figure 1.1: Block diagram of a general digital communication system.

At the transmitter (TX), the information sequence is first processed by a source encoder to remove redundancy, followed by a channel encoder that introduces controlled redundancy to enable error detection. The resulting coded bit sequence is partitioned into blocks of m_c bits, each of which is mapped onto a complex-valued symbol drawn from a constellation $\mathcal{X}$ of size 2^{m_c} . The modulator then converts the symbol sequence into a baseband signal suitable for transmission.

During transmission, the channel distorts the signal due to attenuation, multipath propagation, and additive noise, such that the received signal differs from the transmitted signal.

At the receiver (RX), the demodulator converts the received signal into a sequence of decision variables. These are processed by the detector to obtain estimates of the originally transmitted symbols, which are then mapped back to coded bits. Finally, the channel and source decoders reconstruct the original information sequence.

In this work, we consider a simplified version of this general architecture in order to focus on the aspects most relevant to our study. Source coding and decoding are omitted, and the information is assumed to be available as a sequence of independent and identically distributed (i.i.d.) bits without prior compression or digitization. Channel coding and decoding are also not considered, such that the analysis is restricted to uncoded transmission.

The transmission medium is assumed to be a wireless channel affected by fading and additive noise. Furthermore, the channel is considered to be frequency-flat, meaning that its response remains constant over the entire signal bandwidth. The specific channel models used in this work are introduced in the relevant chapters.

1.2 MIMO Communication Systems

When both the TX and the RX are equipped with multiple antennas, the system is referred to as a multiple-input multiple-output (MIMO) system.

Compared to a single-antenna link, the multiple antennas provide additional spatial degrees of freedom that can be exploited to increase data throughput, improve reliability, or achieve a trade-off between both. Spatial multiplexing techniques enable significant capacity gains by transmitting multiple independent data streams simultaneously over different antennas. A well-known example is the BLAST architecture [2]. Alternatively, spatial diversity can be achieved through space-time coding schemes, which distribute symbols across both space and time to improve robustness against fading. A classical example is the Alamouti scheme [3]. Throughout this work, the focus is on spatial multiplexing and, in particular, on how the simultaneous transmission of multiple data streams over a shared channel can be made most efficient through precoding.

1.2.1 SU-MIMO

In the point-to-point case, where a single TX with N_T antennas communicates with a single RX with N_R antennas, the system is called a single-user (SU) MIMO system. A block diagram is shown in Fig. 1.2.

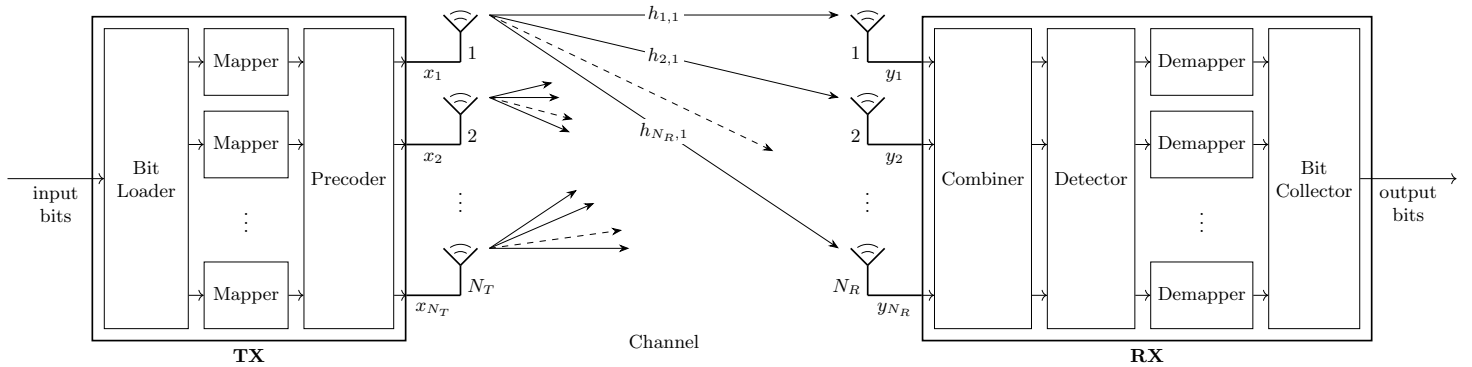


Figure 1.2: Block diagram of a SU-MIMO system.

The discrete-time complex baseband input-output relation of a SU-MIMO Gaussian channel is characterized by

$$\mathbf{y} = \mathbf{H}\mathbf{x} + \mathbf{n}, \quad (1.1)$$

where $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_T \times 1}$ is the transmitted signal vector, $\mathbf{y} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_R \times 1}$ is the received signal vector, $\mathbf{H} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_R \times N_T}$ is the channel matrix, and $\mathbf{n} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_R \times 1}$ is the additive noise vector. The (n_r, n_t) -th entry of $\mathbf{H}$ represents the complex channel coefficient between transmit antenna n_t and receive antenna n_r . The noise vector is assumed to be circularly symmetric complex Gaussian, i.e., $\mathbf{n} \sim \mathcal{N}_{\mathbb{C}}(\mathbf{0}, N_0 \mathbf{I}_{N_R})$, such that its entries are spatially independent, each with an expected power of N_0 . The time index is omitted for brevity.

At the TX, the information bits are divided into N_S streams and mapped onto data symbols, which are collected in the vector $\mathbf{a} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_S \times 1}$. Then, the transmitted signal is obtained by mapping the N_S data symbol streams onto the N_T transmit antennas according to a linear precoding scheme, represented by a matrix $\mathbf{F} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_T \times N_S}$. The transmitted signal can therefore be expressed as

$$\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{F}\mathbf{a}. \quad (1.2)$$

The data symbols are assumed to be zero-mean, mutually uncorrelated, and normalized, such that $\mathbb{E}[\mathbf{a}\mathbf{a}^H] = \mathbf{I}_{N_S}$. Throughout this work, the power allocation is assumed to be incorporated into the precoding matrix, unless explicitly stated otherwise. Under this convention, the total transmit power is constrained by

$$\mathbb{E}[\|\mathbf{x}\|^2] = \text{tr}(\mathbf{F}^H \mathbf{F}) \leq P_t. \quad (1.3)$$

At the RX, the N_R received signals are linearly combined to obtain the decision-variable vector $\mathbf{z} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_S \times 1}$. The combiner is represented by a matrix $\mathbf{G} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_S \times N_R}$. The decision variables can therefore be expressed as

$$\mathbf{z} = \mathbf{G}\mathbf{y}. \quad (1.4)$$

Based on $\mathbf{z}$, the detector forms estimates of the transmitted data symbols, which are then mapped back to bits.

Substituting (1.2) into (1.1) and applying (1.4) yields the relation between the transmitted data symbols and the decision variables:

$$\mathbf{z} = (\mathbf{G}\mathbf{H}\mathbf{F})\mathbf{a} + \mathbf{G}\mathbf{n}, \quad (1.5a)$$

$$= \mathbf{T}\mathbf{a} + \mathbf{n}_G, \quad (1.5b)$$

where $\mathbf{T} \in \mathbb{C}^{N_S \times N_S}$ is the MIMO transfer matrix and $\mathbf{n}_G$ represents spatially correlated Gaussian noise.

1.2.2 MU-MIMO

When multiple receivers are served simultaneously by a single multi-antenna transmitter, the system is referred to as a multi-user (MU) MIMO system. In this context, the transmitter is

called the base station (BS) and the individual receivers are referred to as user terminals (UTs). A block diagram is shown in Fig. 1.3.

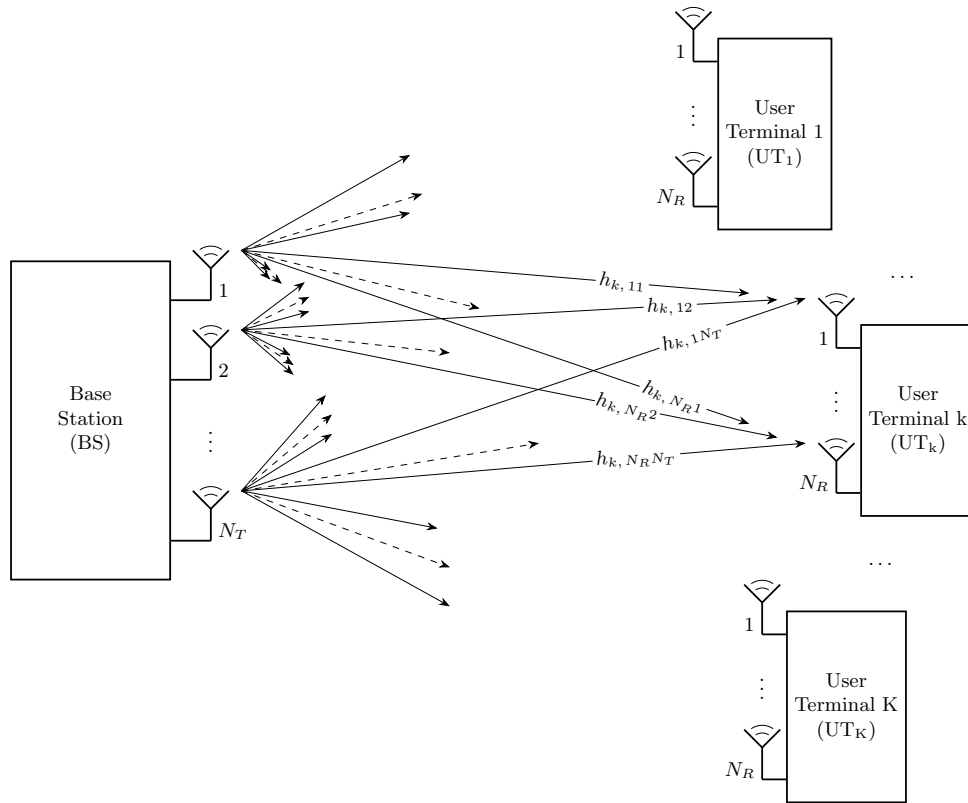


Figure 1.3: Block diagram of a MU-MIMO system.

1.3 Capacity of a MIMO System

1.3.1 SU-MIMO

1.3.2 MU-MIMO

Part II

Precoding with perfect CSI

Part III

Precoding for Satellite Communications

Part IV

Appendices

Bibliography

- [1] M. M. Nele Noels, *Syllabus Communicatietheorie*. Ghent, Belgium: Ghent University, 2022-2023.
- [2] G. Foschini and M. Gans, “On limits of wireless communications in a fading environment when using multiple antennas,” *Wireless Personal Communications*, vol. 6, no. 3, pp. 311–335, Mar. 1998.
- [3] S. Alamouti, “A simple transmit diversity technique for wireless communications,” *IEEE Journal on Selected Areas in Communications*, vol. 16, no. 8, pp. 1451–1458, 1998.